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Chapter 7

Using Email



Why Read This?



Tip: Read this to understand how to set up
Email and use it as part of a Business Process.

Overview

This section gives an overview of how Email works within a Business Process and what you can aim to achieve.



Note: There is also a section called Explorer Email Server Agent in the Explorer online help. Please refer to this for detailed help for each field on the Email Server Agent windows.

Defining An Email Activity

Instead of sending activities to a user or role, so that they appear on the relevant Action List, you may define an activity to send it to an Email location.



Note: Only Manual Activities are currently supported to be sent via Email.

To do this you define the Properties of the link leading to the Manual Activity using Constructor.



Tip: Please refer to the tutorial in the help section called Building AE Processes, Building AE 3, Step 7.

You set the Recipient Type to Email and an appropriate address in the Recipient field.

This is an example:

The screenshot shows the 'Execution Details' dialog box. The 'Schedule Type' section has five radio buttons: 'User Controlled' (selected), 'Automatic Batch', 'Other', 'Automatic Immediate', and 'Scheduled Batch'. There is a 'Multiple object processing' checkbox. Below are three tabs: 'Schedule', 'Roles', and 'Action List'. The 'Action List' tab is active, showing 'Recipient Type' as 'Email', 'Recipient' as 'Admin E-mail', and 'Priority' as 'Normal'. There are also 'Document Type' (SALESORDER), 'Static' (selected), and 'DataField' options. 'Ok' and 'Cancel' buttons are at the bottom right.

You can set up the Email address as a Data Field.

This is an example:

Add Data Field

Data field name: CustEmail Document type: SALESORDER Data field type: Text

Description: Admin E-mail

Data field information: z1admin@z1.co.uk

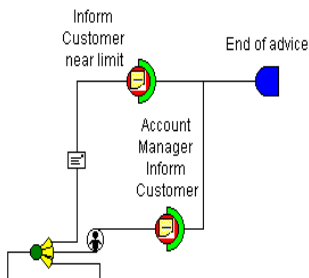
Usage:

- ☐ Role
- ☐ User
- ☒ E-mail address
- ☐ Priority
- ☐ Description

Data type: Alpha string Field length: 80 Decimal places: 0

OK Cancel

You would see an Email symbol, like this below, on the Constructor Workspace.



The Work Management Engine then directs the activity accordingly.

Processing Emails On Activity Lists

In reality, as far as the Work Management Engine on the Server is concerned, Email activities are treated no differently than any other actives which should appear on the Activity List. Indeed emailed activities are placed on the Activity List for a special role called *EMAIL.

To process items on the *EMAIL role Activity List you need to have a copy of System 21 Explorer that runs unattended, usually on another PC or PC Server. This copy of Explorer is signed on to the Server with a role code of *EMAIL and so all Emails appear on the Activity List.

To process the Emails, you run a program called the Email Server Agent, which periodically asks Explorer to tell it all the Activity List items. It then executes each one in turn, sending the text that would have been shown on the screen as a MAPI compliant Email.

Note that this means that the PC acting as the Work Management Email Server must have a configured and operational MAPI Compliant Client, such as Microsoft Exchange Client.

Setting Up And Operating The Email Server Agent

The Email Server Agent forwards Email messages generated by the Work Management Engine. To install this utility you must take the Administration Tools option when installing Explorer. It is designed to run unattended and should be installed onto a network server rather than a user's machine.

The Email Server Agent periodically asks Explorer to tell it all the Activity List items for the role *EMAIL. The Email Server Agent executes each activity in turn, sending the text that would have been shown on the screen as a MAPI compliant Email.

A MAPI-compliant Email system, such as Microsoft Exchange or Windows Messaging, must be installed before using the Email Server Agent.



Note: The PC running the Email Server Agent must have a configured and operational MAPI Compliant Client, such as a Windows Messaging Client.

Activities placed on the action list for the *EMAIL role are Manual Activities with a Recipient Type set to Email.

The information sent back to the Email Server Agent for each action list entry of type Email contains the Email address but not the message. To retrieve the message text the Email Server Agent must run a server task via Explorer, this server task will return the message text to Explorer which will in turn return it to the Email Server Agent, the Email is sent once the message text is received.

All prominent actions carried out by the Email Server Agent are written to a log file JBAMailAct.log. All errors are written to a different log file, JBAMailLerr.log.

Email Server Agent And Windows 95

The Email Server Agent uses Microsoft Active Messaging version 1.1. If you are using Windows 95, since Microsoft Exchange version 4.0, or lower, does not support Active Messaging, to use the Email Server Agent you will have to do one of the following:

- Install the DLL's from the Exchange 4.0 Server release rather than the original Exchange 4.0 client released with Windows 95.
- Install any version of Exchange greater than 4.0.
- Download the explorer installation program, EXUPDUSA.EXE from <ftp://ftp.microsoft.com/softlib/MSLFILES/>.



Note: This is effectively an Exchange 4.0 Service Pack. First make a complete backup, then run the update.

The Explorer installation program tries to register the active messaging component OLEMSG32.DLL. This fails under Windows 95 if your version of Microsoft Exchange does not support Active Messaging.

After you have upgraded Microsoft Exchange, you must manually register OLEMSG32.DLL using the REGSVR32 command. If OLEMSG32.DLL has not been registered correctly, you get a Failure To Create MAPI Session Error when starting the Email Server Agent.

Using The Email Server Agent

Before you can start the Email Server Agent you must first start Explorer. You must use the Email role menu. If this role menu does not exist, you must create it with a role code of *EMAIL.



*Note: All Email messages generated by the Work Management Engine are sent to role code *EMAIL. Therefore if you use any role other than ones with a *EMAIL role code no messages are processed.*

Then start the Email Server Agent from your Start menu. It is one of your options within JBA System 21 program list. When you first start the Email Server Agent running, you must specify which windows messaging profile the agent uses.



Tip: You can configure profiles from the Windows Settings\Control Panel\Mail option.

Once running, the Email Server Agent asks Explorer to refresh it's action list and send the information associated with each action list entry back to the Email Server Agent. The Email Server Agent will process any action list entries that are of type Email.

Shutting Down

If you want to shutdown the Work Management system to which Explorer is connected, you must also shutdown the Email Server Agent and Explorer.

First, press the Stop button and exit the Email Server Agent, then shutdown Explorer.

When you restart the Work Management system, you must also restart Explorer and the Email Server Agent.

Setting The Email Address

To Configure a Manual Activity to be sent via Email, the link into the Manual Activity is set to be of type Email within constructor. (Recipient Type on the Action List tab).

The recipient is then configured (in the Recipient drop down Combo box). This can either be a static Email address or one driven by a data field, according to the settings of the radio buttons below.

If the static option is chosen then a full Email address is entered into the recipient combo box and all instances of Email will be sent to that Email address.

If the data option is chosen then a data field must be selected. The data fields in the drop down combo are all data fields for the document type being processed (for example SALESORDER) which have the Email usage box checked. In this case the Work Management Engine will resolve the Email address on a per instance basis as each process is executed according to the definition of the data variable.

In the case of the sample processes HE1-3, the Email links are set to use a variable called Admin Email. If you look at the definition of this variable you will see that it is defined to be type Text and the text is a hard coded Email address. Normally you would change this to be an SQL variable type with an appropriate SQL statement to retrieve the Email address from appropriate files.



Tip: System 21 has no standard provision for Email addresses to be stored against customers, so either use the descriptions file or create a new extension file.

Resolving The Email Address

Generally, when using Email systems a user entered destination Email name is validated against an address book and a complete (validated) Email address is calculated. However it is common to ignore the address lookup and validation stage, if the supplied name has an @ in it. Therefore emailing to a user called Fred will cause a lookup in the address book (with an error if Fred cannot be found). Whilst Fred@acme.com will be transmitted without checks.

This same scheme is employed by the Work Management Engine. The Email address (either statistically defined or resolved at runtime from an data variable) is passed into the Email server agent. The server agent checks for the presence of an @ and if none is found, it first asks for the Email address from the local address book as defined by the MAP1 configuration on the Email server agent PC.